

Switching apps is simple enough, just click or tap an app thumbnail to switch to it. These applications are sorted by recency, with the most recent app at the top. If you are running too many apps, some might no longer show up as they disappear at the bottom. You can get back to these “hidden” apps by clicking on the apps tile in the start screen, it should be up and running where you left it.

Since there are two kinds of applications running on the Windows system, things can get a little confusing. This confusion arises from the fact that there are multiple places that show running applications, but the applications they show are different and inconsistent.

In desktop mode the taskbar will not show Modern UI apps, however they will appear while Alt-tabbing. The new app switcher does not show desktop apps but it does show the desktop itself. This desktop tile can be “closed” but that just hides the tile, the desktop is still running.



The IE10 app bars include its location bar and tab bar

So as a quick guide:

Taskbar: shows ONLY desktop apps

Alt-tab: shows both desktop and Modern UI apps

Win-tab: shows ONLY Modern UI apps + desktop

There are a couple of other tricks you can use with the task manager.

If you are using the mouse, you can move the mouse to the top-left corner of the screen and you will see the last used app, you can just click here to switch to that app.

We said earlier that you can't arbitrarily resize Windows 8 apps. You can, however, snap an application to the left or right side of the screen. If you do so the app will take up one column of the screen, while another application can happily run alongside it.

Say you are listening to music, and browsing the internet. You can snap the music player to one side of the screen while you continue browsing.